

## CHABAD OF PARKLAND

## והיה כִּי־תבוא אֶל־הָאָרֶץ

*VehHoyoh Ki Sovoi El HoOretz*

Maamor — free translation & elucidation · Shabbos Parshas Ki Savo 5743 · bilti-mugah

### ⌘ MAAMOR

And it will be, when you come into the land which HaShem, your G-d, gives you for an inheritance, and you possess it and settle in it.”

Mitzvah of the first fruits: To bring the first of the fruits and produce to the Beis HaMikdosh.

Into the land: Which implies that

Our Parsha begins with a Possuk:

וְהָיָה כִּי־תבוא אֶל־הָאָרֶץ “ אֲשֶׁר ה' אֱלֹהֶיךָ נֹתֵן לְךָ נַח לְהִירָשׁ וְיָשַׁבְתָּ בָּהּ

**And it will be, when you come into the land which HaShem, your G-d, gives you for an inheritance, and you possess it and settle in it.”**

Possuk: (Devorim 26:1) וְהָיָה כִּי־תבוא אֶל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר ה' אֱלֹהֶיךָ נֹתֵן לְךָ נַח לְהִירָשׁ וְיָשַׁבְתָּ בָּהּ

The Possuk continues to explain the Mitzvah of Bikkurim, the Mitzvah of the first fruits, which the B'nei Yisroel were commanded to perform upon their entry into the land of Eretz Yisroel. However, we need to understand why the Possuk specifically chose to make this Mitzvah of Bikkurim dependent upon the B'nei Yisroel's entering into the land. they were obligated to bring Bikkurim as soon as the B'nei Yisroel arrive in the land of Eretz Yisroel. Yet we learn that they were obligated to bring Bikkurim only after they conquered and divided up the land. Entering the Land: But there is no Mitzvah to bring Bikkurim when in the diaspora.

Divide up the land: Of the Shevotim, until each Shevet is settled in their own portion of land. This is why the Mitzvah of Bikkurim only became an

actuality fourteen years after the B'nei Yisroel entered the Eretz Yisroel.

#### CONCEPT

Talmud states: (Zevachim 118b) the Sages taught: The days of the Ohel Moed (Tent of Meeting) in the wilderness were forty years, less one year. The days of the Ohel Moed in Gilgal were fourteen years: Seven years during which the Jews conquered the land and seven years during which they divided the land among the tribes. Or the Talmud states elsewhere: (Niddah 47a) "Even according to the one who says that Terumah nowadays is only Rabbinic, Challah is Biblical for in the time of Yehoshua during the seven years that the B'nei Yisroel conquered Eretz Yisroel and the seven years that they apportioned it among the tribes

Furthermore, our Sages of Blessed Memory have said in the Talmud( Rashi brings it in his explanation on the Torah), that the B'nei Yisroel would be obligated to perform the Mitzvah of Bikkurim only after they were to conquer and divide up the land; as the Talmud states: In the Talmud: Kiddushin (37b) it states that only after the inheriting and settling of Eretz Yisroel is complete, does the Mitzvah of appointing a king come into effect: ... so too, wherever coming to the land is mentioned without qualification, it means after inheritance and settlement. .... but also, the Mitzvah of first fruits, where the verse also uses the terms of coming, inheriting, and dwelling. Rashi: Rabbi Shlomo Yitzchaki, Troyes, France 1040-1105, author of the commentary on the Talmud and Tanach, virtually all published copies of the Chumash and of Talmud include Rashi's commentary. Rashi brings it: On the words of the Possuk: 'And it will be, when you come... and you possess it and settle in it' Rashi says: This verse, which is immediately followed by the commandment of bringing Bikkurim, teaches us that they were not obligated to bring "first fruits" until they conquered the Land and divided it. - [Kidushin 37b]

"seven years they conquered and seven years they divided". **ו**In that case, **ו**why did the Torah choose to render this Mitzvah of Bikkurim dependant on their entering the land?**ו** Moreover, even according to what is written in the Sifri**ו** they were obligated in the Mitzvah of Challah but they were not obligated in the Mitzvah of Maaser or Terumah. Seven years they conquered: from the hold of the seven nations. As the Torah instructed (Bereishis 15:18/21) On that day, HaShem formed a covenant with Avrom, saying, "To your seed I have given this land, from the river of Egypt until the great river, the Euphrates river. The Kenites, the Kenizzites, and the Kadmonites, And the Hittites and the Perizzites and the Rephaim, And the Amorites and the Canaanites and the Girgashites and the Jebusites. **ו**Seven years they divided: As the Possuk states in Yehoshua (14:10) And now, behold, HaShem has kept me alive, as He spoke, these fortyfive years, from the time HaShem spoke this word to Moshe, while the B'nei Yisroel walked in the wilderness; and now, behold, I am this day eighty-five years old. And Rashi states on the words: these forty-five years: We learn that the conquest of the land took seven years, for in the second year, Moshe sent the spies. There remain thirty-eight years, during which the B'nei Yisroel walked through the wilderness, and seven in which

they conquered the land, making a total of forty-five years. ב If that is the case: If in hindsight they brought Bikkurim only when they settled fourteen years after entering the land, then why did HaShem who knows the future beforehand instruct the entry into Eretz Yisroel as a prerequisite to keeping this Mitzvah, which implies that the Mitzvah is valid immediately upon their entrance into the land? ג Entering the land: when in hindsight there was a fourteen-year gap between the two. ד Sifri: A Halachic Medrash on Sefer Bamidbar and on Sefer Devorim. The books of Bereishis

that “whenever the word ‘וַיָּהֵא’ is used it implies immediately”, implying that the Mitzvah of Bikkurim [would be] applicable immediately, as they entered the land. However, ז Even here ‘immediately’ doesn’t literally mean “immediately”, because they needed to bring Bikkurim “וַיָּהֵא” To the place which HaShem will choose” ח as and Shmos are covered by the ‘Mechilta’ and Vayikra is covered by the ‘Sifra’. ט Whenever the word ‘וַיָּהֵא’ is used it implies immediately: The Sifri says on this Possuk our Parsha (Devorim 26:1) where it says

וַיָּהֵא כִּי " תְּבוּאָה אֶל־הָאָרֶץ

**And it shall be when you come to the land”: (whenever the word ‘וַיָּהֵא’**

וַיָּהֵא is used it implies immediately) “Perform the Mitzvah mentioned herein, in whose merit you are entering the land”. In other words, the Mitzvah is more important than entering the land and is incumbent as soon as you enter the land. ז However: Even according to the Sifri who holds that this Mitzvah becomes mandatory immediately upon entering into the land, which means that they could not wait around without doing it for fourteen years nevertheless.... י First fruits: To an area already designated and a ready-completed Beis HaMikdosh. יא Will choose: Which means, they had to first establish which was the location that HaShem was choosing as His place for a Mishkon at that time and thereafter a place for the Beis HaMikdosh. The Rambam traces the illustrious history of Shilo in Hilchos Beis HaBechira (1:2): “After they entered the land, they set up the Mishkon in Gilgal for the fourteen years they conquered and divided, and from there they came to Shiloh and built a house of stones and spread the curtains of the Mishkon over it, and there was no ceiling there. The Mishkon of Shiloh stood for 369 years. After Eli died by the sword, they came to Nov and built the Mishkon there, and when Shmuel Hanovi died it was destroyed and they came to

the Possuk states:

**and for this [to take] effect they first had to build in actuality a Mishkon.”**  
**But seemingly, there were Mitzvos which the B’nei Yisroel were obligated to**  
**perform even before this stage, כאל immediate**

ly as they set foot into Eretz Yisroel. כב An example [of this concerns] the Mitzvah of  
“Challah”, כג which was obligatory, immediately upon the Givon and built the Mikdosh  
there. And from Givon they came to the Eternal House in Yerushalayim, and the days of Nov  
and Givon were 57 years.” In other words, the Mishkon stood in Shilo for most of the 480  
years stretching from the time the B’nei Yisroel left Mitzrayim until Shlomo Hamelech built  
the Beis HaMikdosh in Yerushalayim. ט Possuk states: Devrim (26:2)

ו ל ק ח ת מ ר א ש י ת כ ל פ ר י ה א ד מ א ש ר ת ב י א מ א ר צ ח א ש ר ה א ל ק י ד נ  
ת נ ל ח ו ש מ ת ב ט נ א ו ה ל כ ת א ל ה מ ק ו מ א ש ר “ י ב ח ר ה א ל ק י ד ל ש כ נ ש מ ו  
ש ם

**You shall take of the first of all the fruit of the ground, which you will bring**  
**from your land, which HaShem, your G-d, is giving you.**

And you shall put them into a basket and go to the place which HaShem, your G-d, will  
choose to have His Name dwell there.” Build a Mishkon: Obviously ‘immediately’ cannot  
mean literally as the B’nei Yisroel first needed to conquer, divide the land, build a temple, reap,  
harvest and bring the fruits to it - a process of many years. כא Before this stage: Before building  
the Mishkon. כב Set foot into Eretz Yisroel: And became mandatory straight away. כג Mitzvah  
of Challah: As is explicit in Parshas Shelach (Bamidbor 15:18)

ד ב ר א ל ב נ י י ש ר א ל ו א מ ר ת א ל ה ם ב ב א כ ם א ל ה א ר ץ א ש ר א נ י מ ב י א  
“ א ת כ ם ש מ א

**Speak to the B’nei Yisroel and you shall say to them, When you arrive in the**  
**Land to which I am bringing you”**

and Rashi says on the words of the Possuk: When you arrive in the Land: Heb. לב ב א כ ם lit.,  
when you come to the

B’nei Yisroel’s entrance into the Land, and there are some who even [go as far as to] say that  
the obligation to take Challah also became mandatory regarding any dough which they might  
have found when they entered the land. כד We can see that at a basic level, regarding the  
Mitzvah of ‘Challah’, whereby the performance of the physical act of separating the ‘Challah’  
element from the dough enables the remaining dough to become permitted for consumption  
כה even before the separated dough was Land This ‘coming’ differs from all the other

‘comings’ in the Torah. For with the others, Scripture states, “כִּי תָבֹא” when you will come” in the singular or plural ; כִּי תִבְאוּ ; therefore, all of them learn a particular law from each other. Since in one of their cases, Scripture specifies that it applies only after inheritance and settling in the Land, it therefore applies in all cases. But here it uses the term כִּם בֹּא as soon as they arrived there and ate from its bread, they were obligated to separate a portion of the dough. - [Sifri Shelach 21] כִּד When they entered the land: I.e. Dough which had already been prepared before they entered the land which they might have found there when they arrived is now obligated with the Mitzvah of Challah. This highlights the fact that this Mitzvah became mandatory immediately upon their entrance into the land. כֹּח Consumption: By anyone, even a non-Kohen.

given on high. כִּז This is unlike the Mitzvah of Bikkurim where the new fruits and produce themselves need to be brought to the place “Which HaShem will choose...”. כִּז However, accordingly, we [still] need clarification! What is the significance of the emphasis in the Possuk that the Mitzvah of Bikkurim comes into effect immediately upon the B’nei Yisroel’s arrival into Eretz Yisroel? כִּח We are therefore [forced to] conclude that there is a spiritual significance that relates to the spiritual element כִּז Given on high: In other words: When one makes a batch of dough that meets the criteria of the Mitzvah of Challah, then that whole batch of dough cannot be consumed by a non-Kohen because of the obligation to give part of this dough to the Kohen. Once the required amount of dough has been separated from the batch the rest of the dough immediately becomes permitted for consumption even before that separated piece of dough has actually been given away. (Nowadays where the Beis HaMikdash is not built in the material world that piece is burned to cinders and discarded). כִּז Will choose: unlike the Mitzvah of ‘Challah’, the separation of the dough itself sufficed as the Mitzvah. With Bikkurim however, they actually need to be given to the Temple. כִּח Into Eretz Yisroel: Especially when in reality the Mitzvah of Bikkurim (Unlike the Mitzvah of Challah) only came into effect fourteen years later after they had conquered and divided the land.

of the Mitzvah of Bikkurim on which entering the land depends. In other words, although the practical element of the Mitzvah of Bikkurim only comes into effect at a later stage כִּט the spiritual significance is relevant immediately. We can understand this [כִּל with a preface] based on that which is brought in a Medrash “כִּל Moshe Rabbeinu of כִּט At a later stage: As explained above that it would be practically impossible to bring the Bikkurim straight away. Relevant immediately: As will be explained. כִּל We can understand this: Deeper spiritual meaning of the separation of Challah. כִּל Medrash: Tanchuma Ki Sova (chapter 1): the Possuk in our Parshah (Devorim 26:17) says: “.

הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה ה' אֵל הַיָּד מִצֹּר לַעֲשׂוֹת

**This day, HaShem, your G-d, is commanding you to perform”**

this is consistent with the Possuk in Tehillim (95:6) that says:

בואו נשתחו ונהונכרעה נברכה לפניה' עו שנו

**“Come, let us prostrate ourselves and bow; let us kneel before**

HaShem, our Maker.” Why the double expression? Is prostrating oneself not the same as bowing, and is bowing not the same as prostration? So what is the significance that the Possuk states all three? It is because Moshe perceived with Divine foresight and saw that the Beis HaMikdosh would eventually be destroyed and the Mitzvah of Bikkurim would cease. He took action and established prayers thrice daily because HaShem enjoys our prayers even more than he enjoys all our good deeds and our animal sacrifices as the Possuk (Tehillim 141:2) states:

תכון תפלתיקטרלתפניךמשאתכפימנחתערב

.

“My prayer shall be established like incense before

blessed memory perceived with Divine intervention and saw that the Beis HaMikdosh would eventually be destroyed and the Mitzvah of Bikkurim would cease. He took action and established prayers thrice daily. לג. You, the lifting of my hands as the evening offering”. And even though Moshe RaBeinu did many good deeds, when HaShem decreed upon him that he would not enter Eretz Yisroel he prayed and said (Devorim 3:25)

אעברהנאו ארה

**“Please let me cross over and see the good land ”**

עלה (Devorim 3:26/7) And HaKodosh Boruch Hu said

אלתוסףדבראלי עוד בדבר הזה ראשה פסגה

**Do not speak to me further about this matter Go up to the top of the hill.**

“: This is why the Torah (Devorim 26:17) says:

**This day, HaShem, your G-d, is commanding you to perform”.**

And above the Possuk says:

ה ש קי פה “ מ מעון ק ד שך

**Look down from Your holy dwelling”**

(And as Rashi states: We have fulfilled what You have decreed upon us. Now You do what is incumbent upon You to do (Sifri, Ma’aser Sheni 5:13), for You said, “If you follow My statutes... then I shall give you your rains in their proper time....” (Vayikra. 26:3-4).) Rabbi Avohu says in the name of Rabbi Yossi ben Chaninah: “Come and see how many people sin and yet how much opportunity those who do Mitzvos have to express themselves. Whilst a human who has dealings with the kingdom sometimes can pay monies until a time when he can meet with the king, and then there is a chance the king will fulfil his request but there is a chance that he won’t. But HaKodosh Boruch Hu is not like that. As soon as one sees a ripe bunch of grapes, a ripe fig or a ripe pomegranate, he places it in a basket and takes it to Yerushalayim and he stands in the middle of the courtyard at the Beis HaMikdosh and pleads for mercy on behalf of himself, the B’nei Yisroel and Eretz Yisroel as the Possuk states: “

ה ש קי פה מ מעון ק ד שך

**Look down from Your holy dwelling.”**

Furthermore, he says “I am not budging from here until you take care of my needs” as the Possuk says afterwards:

היום ה זה ה' אל היך

“.

מ צוך ל עשות

**This day, HaShem, your G-d, is commanding you to perform”.**

17 Established prayers thrice daily: In order that the essence and spiritual significance of prayers

The interpretation of this Medrash is that the Mitzvah of Bikkurim within a person's Avodah is the symbolic equivalent to the Avodah of prayer. For in general, 17our sages of blessed memory say that "The prayers were established to substitute 17the animal sacrifices". 17 should achieve what the essence and spiritual significance of the Mitzvah of Bikkurim had achieved up until then. 17In general: regarding Prayer in general. 17To substitute: The Alter Rebbe writes in Shulchan Oruch Horav: (OC 98:4) Prayer was established in place of animal sacrifices, therefore, one must be careful to follow the example of the animal sacrifices. In ones focus one should not allow in any foreign thoughts as in the thoughts which disqualify a Kodshim sacrifice. One needs to pray the Amidah standing as one did with the Avodah at the offering. One should have a fixed place to pray as with the animal sacrifices that each had its place where it was to be slaughtered and where to place its blood. One should not have anything dividing between himself and the wall when he prays just as an obstruction between the vessel and the sacrifice disqualifies. He should wear appropriate clothes which are designated for prayer akin to the Kohen's clothes although we can not imitate them one shall still have nice designated trousers for prayer because of cleanliness (Even though Halachically one does not really need them because one does not need them for prayer more than one does for Torah study and for Torah study one can wear dirty trousers). 17Animal sacrifices: As explained at length in Chassidus that the spiritual dimension of the animal sacrifices is about the person bringing the sacrifice coming closer to HaShem. This is also the concept

However, after close inspection of all sacrifices and offerings, 'prayer' [actually] corresponds most directly to the offering of the Mitzvah of Bikkurim. This unique connection 17is best understood through an explanation by the Tzemach Tzedek 17in his work the 'Ohr Hatorah' where he writes: "There are two aspects to the Mitzvah of Bikkurim - The first is the physical act of prayer as we know that the word for prayer 'Tefillah' comes from the word Tofel as the Mishneh writes: (Keilim 3:5)

הטו פל כ לי ח רס

**which means if one plasters (lays on and connects plaster to) a clay vessel which translates in prayer as a deep-rooted connection in one's Avodas Hashem of one's soul in its root in G-dliness.**

The Friediker Rebbe writes in Sefer Hamaamorim 5709 (79pp) that the Avodah of 'Tefillah' is the closeness and the cleaving to G-dliness which is the concept of 'Tefillah' meaning connection and tying together which is the translation of the word 'Tefillah' from the word

**which means to connect.**

זל This unique connection: Between the Mitzvah of Bikkurim and the Mitzvah of prayer.  
 חל Tzemach Tzedek: Rabbi Menachem Mendel Schneerson, the Tzemach Tzedek of Lubavitch 1789 - 1866. Third Rebbe of Lubavich and the son-in-law of the Mittlerer Rebbe. Produced authoritative responsa on many areas of Jewish law called Tzemach Tzedek. As well as Derech Mitzvosecho, Biurei Hazohar, Ohr Hatorah, Sefer Chakirah, Sefer Halikutim & Sefer Hamaamorim. Among his famous quotes is “Tracht gut vet Zein gut — Think good and it will be good.”

of separating the first fruit and the physical act of bringing the Bikkurim; טל the second is the reading of the section in the Torah which discusses Bikkurim as the Possuk states:“

ועניתו אמרת

**And you shall call out and say...”.** חא The difference between these two aspects is, מב that the essence of the Mitzvah of bringing Bikkurim is an

טל Bringing the Bikkurim: To the Mishkon or to the Beis HaMikdosh. Possuk states: (Devorim 26:5)

ועניתו אמרת לפני ה' אל קיר ארמי אבדאבי וירד מצרימה ויגר שם במתי מעט “ ויחיי שם לגוי גדול עצום ורב

**And you shall call out and say before HaShem, your G-d, "An Aramean sought to destroy my forefather, and he went down to Egypt and sojourned there with a small number of people, and there, he became a great, mighty, and numerous nation.”**

חא Call out and say: Words of thanks and appreciation to HaShem. Thanking HaShem for taking us out from Mitzrayim and more (Starting with the words: “An Aramean sought to destroy my forefather” which are the Pesukim that are expounded upon in the Haggadah for Pesach). מב Two aspects: The difference between separating and bringing the Bikkurim to reading out the Torah scripts associated with the Bikkurim offering is... חא Is: In Chassidus it is explained that there are two routes a person can take to become close to HaShem: One is ‘לה אה Elevating’ which connotes a person who arouses himself and does things to ascend from below to above. And the second route is מה שכה ‘Drawing down’ when one’s closeness is inspired by an arousal from above to below. Generally, this is also the difference

between 'Prayer' which is about **ע ל אה** because it is primarily about one's Avodah in his heart, and 'Torah study' which is about **ה מ ש כה** because the Torah comes from above.

Avodah from below to above, **מד** because we separate all of the Bikkurim from the rest of the fruits **מה** and bring them up to "The place which HaShem will choose..." **מו**. Whereas, the reading **מו** of the Bikkurim section in Torah, is, about drawing down Divine inspiration from above to below. This is so because in essence the reading serves to publicize the great kindnesses of HaShem towards the B'nei Yisroel in a loud voice, when he says: "An Aramean sought to destroy my forefather..." **מח** and more specifically how HaShem has shown him **מט** personally **מד** Below to above: Which as mentioned is about a person coming closer to HaShem on his own effort. **מה** The rest of the fruits: The rest of his fruits which he has laboured to produce. **מו** HaShem will choose: And by doing so one effectuates that the regular material fruit are elevated to become an object of a Mitzvah that will be brought up on to the Mishkon or Mikdosh. **מו** The reading: Is about coming closer to HaShem because of the **ה מ** **ה כה** **ש** from above. **מח** Sought to destroy my forefather: This verse, also in our Parsha, goes on to enumerate HaShem's kindness that he did to the B'nei Yisroel collectively as in took us out of Egypt. These passages are also brought in the Pessach Hagadah and are expounded upon there. **מט** HaShem has shown him: Personally, the individual who is

kindness. The announcement must be in a loud voice as the Possuk states:

**ה ג ד תי היום לה' אל קיך נ**

**I declare this day to HaShem, your G-d". נא With this we can understand why the prayers were established as a substitute for the sacrifices, because these two differences נב are likewise found in praye**

r. נג Prayer is akin **נד** to a "

**ס לם מצב ארצה וראשו מגיעה שמימה**

**A**

bringing Bikkurim goes on to thank HaShem for his personal success as in the crop that his field has yielded as the Possuk goes on to say:

**ו עתה הנה הבאתי את ראשית פרי "ה אדמה אשר נתת לי ה**

**And now, behold, I have brought the first of the fruit of the ground which you, HaShem, have given to me."**

” HaShem swore to our forefathers to give us.” I declare...HaShem your G-d: The text that one says when bringing the Bikkurim highlights how all the sustenance primarily comes from above to below. Two differences: of אלה ע ל and נג. Found in prayer: As they are in Bikkurim. Prayer is akin: As the Possuk says: (Bereishis 28:12)

וי חלם והנה סלם מצב ארצה וראשו מגיעה שמימה “ והנה מלאכי אל  
קים עליהם וירדים בו

### And he dreamed and behold!

a ladder set up on the ground and its top reached to heaven; and behold,

ladder set up on the ground and its top reaches the heaven”, meaning, it is a ladder through which our prayers rise up on high, hence an “elevation” from below to above. And then afterwards, through the ladder of prayer, and because of the prayers, the Hamshochos descend from the heavens down to earth to fulfil the needs of the person who is praying. angels of HaShem were ascending and descending upon it” Reaches the heaven: Akin to the ladder in Yaakov’s dream about which the Torah tells us it was tall from the ground up until the heaven. It is explained in Chassidus that this is a parable for prayer which is a medium by which a person who is standing on the ground can connect to G-dliness, the heaven. Rise on up high: Prayer is analogous to a ladder. Just as a ladder is a medium by which to ascend up from below to above so too prayer is a ladder by which one can ascend from his lowly situation and to ascend spiritually from below to above. Ladder of prayer: A person merits that his prayers are heard on high and as a result of which .... Hamshochos: The sustenance the blessing the health and success and the fulfilment of all the other blessings that he might have prayed for. Person who is praying: So, prayer is not only about an elevation and ascent from below to above, it is also about about a drawing down and elicitation from above to below. This is the same as it is with the Mitzvah of Bikkurim where the separating and bringing of the fruit

And with this we can understand something additional; the Bikkurim need to be taken from the “first of all the fruits of the land”, meaning from the portion of the choicest, most praiseworthy fruits. As the Rambam writes that we can extrapolate from the Possuk’s language “ כל לב לה “ All fats are for is the elevation and the drawing down is in the reading of the Torah passages. Meaning: Not just from the first chronologically as in which ones grew first, but also the first in quality. Rambam writes: (Issurei Mizbeiach 7:11) “Since all of these categories of oil are acceptable, why were they listed as separate categories? So that one would know the superior category that nothing surpasses, those which are equal, and those which are inferior. In this way, one who desires to gain merit for himself, subjugate

his evil inclination, and amplify his generosity should bring his sacrifice from the most desirable and superior type of the item he is bringing. For it is written in the Torah (Bereishis 4:4):

והבל הביא גם הוא מבכורות צאנו ומחלב הן

"

וישעה'אלהבלואלמנחתו

**And Hevel brought from his chosen flocks and from the superior ones and HaShem turned to Hevel and his offering."**

The same applies to everything given for the sake of the Almighty who is good. It should be of the most attractive and highest quality. If one builds a house of prayer, it should be more attractive than his own dwelling. If he feeds a hungry person, he should feed him from the best and most tasty foods of his table. If he clothes one who is naked, he should clothe him with his attractive garments. If he consecrates something, he should consecrate the best of his possession. And so (Vayikra 3:16) states: "כל חלב לה" All of the superior quality should be given to HaShem." Possuk's language: (Vayikra 3:16)

והקטירם הכהן מזבח חלה לחם

HaShem", that everything which is for HaShem must be from the best, the most praiseworthy. The same is true concerning prayer and the two previous mentioned components of prayer. For prayer itself derives from the highest place in a person's soul. As is understood that the time of prayer is when a person contemplates and 'understands before "

אשה לריח ניחח כל חלב לה

**The Kohen shall cause it to go up in smoke on the altar, consumed as a fire offering, with a pleasing fragrance.**

. All sacrificial fat belongs to HaShem." Everything which is for HaShem: Sacrifices, gifts, tithes and similar. The most praiseworthy: Just as the fats which are the best and richest

part of the animal. ה True with prayer: Which parallels Bikkurim, in this detail as well that one's prayer needs to be from the choicest and best. ו Components of prayer: In both components of ה ל אה and ה ש כה prayer needs to be from the best and choicest faculties of a person. ז Highest place in a person's soul: Prayer comes from one's mind's contemplation, and from an arousal of one's heart's feeling which are one's "inner and sublime faculties", the 'good and the most praiseworthy' of a person's soul.

## לזכות אילנה רפאילה בת שרה לרפואה שלימה וקרובה

whom he is standing', נ which causes ט his prayers to come from the 'choicest' and 'most praiseworthy' of his faculties. Similarly, the Hamshocha from above to below א is absolutely perfect. ב This is because HaShem gives ג from "His full, open, holy and generous hand" ד. This is נ He is standing: As the words of our Sages of Blessed Memory who have stated in the Talmud and is brought down in Halocho that when Davening the Amidah prayer, one needs to stand with the attitude that he is standing in front of the King of Kings HaKodosh Boruch Hu. ט Which causes: And arouses. His faculties: Because since he is standing in front of HaShem he will most certainly put in an effort to pray with his best faculties and this is an elevation from below to above. א Above from below: Which comes as a result of his prayers. ב Absolutely perfect: It is a full and complete Divine influence. ג HaShem gives: To a person and extends to him from above to below in a complete and perfect manner. Just as we say in Birkas Hamazon that the influence comes from HaShem's full, open, holy and generous hand. ד Full, open, holy and generous hand: This is a phrase borrowed from Bentching and elsewhere it is explained, that these four aspects, (which describe HaShem's greatness and the greatness of the Hamshocha and influence that we receive from heaven) the full, open, holy and generosity of HaShem's "hand" correspond to the four letters of HaShem's holy name "Havaya".

extended ה from HaShem's holy name "Havaya", ו from the whole of the name "Havaya" ז from the 'Yud' ח down to the last 'Hey' ט which is drawn from the spiritual world of 'Atzilus' into the three spiritually ע This is extended: In addition to the fact that this sustenance and Divine influence is coming with so many aspects from a 'Full, open, holy and generous hand' it is also coming from the lofty level of the almighty name Havaya. ו Havaya: The holy tetragrammaton, HaShem's fourletter ineffable name, made up of the letters (Which are not allowed to be pronounced in sequence) Yud, Kay, Vov and kay, a uniquely exalted level of HaShem's name. ז The whole of the name Havaya: This influence is extended from a very high lofty place and is extended to the very lowest levels. As this is hinted to in this name that the four letters Yud, Kay, Vov and kay express this concept that the influence is given from the highest highs to the lowest lows. ח From the letter Yud: Which is the first letter in HaShem's holy tetragrammaton which alludes to the highest spiritual levels and the very source of Divine sustenance. ט Last Hey: That alludes to the sustenance that is granted to the lowest of levels. Spiritual world of Atzilus: World of Emanation, the highest of the four spiritual worlds.

Atzilus, Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah. Atzilus is the realm of spiritual existence which, although encompassing attributes which have a specific definition, is in a state of infinity and at one with the Infinite Divine Light. Also called Atzilus from the word Eitzel meaning next-to because it is right next to Hashem.

lower worlds of 'Beriyah', 'Yetzirah' and 'Asiyah'. As is hinted to in the words of the verse

ב רא תיו י צ ר תיו אף־ פד " ע שי תיו

**I created, I formed him, I made him”.**

This is extended into the three garments of the soul 'Thought', 'Speech' and 'Action' and thence into the physical Beriah: The world of creation more specifically creation ex nihilo. Beriyah is a lower level spiritual world than the spiritual world of Atzilus. Beriah represents the realm of spiritual existence which represents the first beginnings of a consciousness of self. Yetzirah; World of Formation, the realm of spiritual existence in which the limited nature of the created beings takes on form and definition; the abode of the lower classes of angelic beings and of the souls of ordinary Jews. Assiah; World of Action, this refers to the lowest of the four spiritual worlds, the final level in the creative process which includes the physical universe, which is what we refer to as 'The world'. The verse: (Yeshaya 43:7) Also quoted in Pirkei Ovos (Chapter 6:11)

כל ה נ ק רא ב ש מי ו ל כבו די ב רא תיו " י צ ר תיו אף־ ע שי תיו

**Everyone that is called by My name, and whom I created for My glory, I formed him,**

yea I made him.” The words

ו ל כבו די ב רא תיו י צ ר תיו אף־ ע שי תיו

**allude to the four groups of spiritual worlds: 'Atzilus', 'Beriyah', 'Yetzirah'**

and 'Asiyah'. Thought Speech and Action: The Divine influence is granted into one's spiritual garments. The Alter Rebbe writes in Tanya (chapter 4) every Divine soul possesses three garments. These are three auxiliary powers, which are its instruments of expression. Like garments, they can be donned or shed at will. When the soul utilizes any of these three powers

it is “clothed” in them; when it does not use them, it is “divested” of them. Also, just as garments give expression to their wearer’s beauty and importance, so, too, when the soul dons and utilizes these “garments”, its intellect and emotion find expression. They (the garments) are: thought, speech and action as they find expression in the 613 commandments of the Torah.

faculties 19 Of ‘Thought’, ‘Speech’ and ‘Action’ of the one who is serving HaShem. 20 This then is the meaning of our Possuk:

וְהָיָה כִּי־תָבוֹא אֶל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר ה' אֱלֹהֶיךָ נֹתֵן לָךְ נַח לְהִירָשׁ וְיָשַׁבְתָּ בָּהּ

**And it will be, when you come into the land which HaShem, your G-d, gives you for an inheritance, and you possess it and settle in it.”**

פח There is a well-known teaching of the Ba'al Shem Tov 19 on our Possuk: “

וְהָיָה כִּי־תָבוֹא אֶל־הָאָרֶץ

**And it will be,**

19 Physical faculties: And then the influence even goes into the tools a person uses to interact in this world with himself through his thoughts and with others through his speech and action. 20 Serving HaShem: Because of one’s “best and choicest” deep prayer, they can draw down HaShem’s highest blessings to the lowest depths of their external thought, speech and action, hence a ‘Hamshocha’ from above to below, the second aspect of both Bikkurim and prayer. פח Settle in it: Now we can understand the spiritual significance of this Possuk which corresponds with what was explained earlier that the Mitzvah of Bikkurim includes both ה ע and ל אה Baal Shem Tov: Rabbi Yisroel Baal Shem Tov or Besht (16981760), Founder of the Chassidic Movement, was a Jewish mystical rabbi and a leader who revolutionized Jewish thought and breathed new life into a fainting nation. The effects of his teachings continue to be felt today—both by his direct followers, known as Chassidim, and by followers of all other streams of Jewish thought, who’ve been deeply impacted by his teachings and philosophy.

when you come into the land”, that the word for land ארץ has two interpretations: Firstly the word מרוצה meaning running hastily and a second interpretation is from the word: “

שָׂרָצַת תֵּהֵא לַעֲשׂוֹת רָצוֹן קוֹנֵנִי

She wants to carry out the will of her maker”.

She wants to carry out the will of her Maker: The word רץ is like the word רצון meaning to ‘want’ which refers to the desire and yearning from below to above. As the Possuk in the vision of the supernal chariot says רצו which is a cleaving to get closer to G-dliness to the extent of demise and שוב which is the return. צא From below to above: The motion of one wanting to do something down here on this world for HaShem on high is the motion of from below to above. צב This: Want and yearning of the spiritual רץ א forms a closeness between the lowly ground with lofty levels in G-dliness. צג Down thereafter: In a manner of from above to below. צד Settling manner: This signifies an internal absorption (unlike running or wanting which are about yearning for something that is lacking and therefore is lacking the calm and opposite to being settled).

Until ‘lights’ צה are drawn down into ‘vessels’ צו. And just as the Possuk צז continues“

ו ש מ ת ב ט נ א צ ח

**And you shall place them (The fruits) in a basket”, which basically means, the receptacle.**

צט Specifically according to that which is known [and taught]; the word ‘ נ א ’ is an acronym for: ‘ ט ע מ י ם ’ which are the musical notes, ‘ ו ד ו ת ’ which are the vowels, and ‘ א ’ which are the Lights: HaShem’s energy is compared to light in this world for several reasons: Light is spiritual you cannot touch it. Light transforms everything it encounters. You can light as many candles from one light and it does not diminish the original light. It is explained in Chassidus, there is a supernal spiritual world in which the lights are very many and the vessels are few, as a result the lights are not contained or established into the vessels. This world is called the world of ‘Tohu’. Unlike all the other worlds in which the lights do settle into the vessels which are called the worlds of ‘Tikkun’ – rectification. צו Vessels: The supernal Sefiros, illuminate and influence by way of pervading that the supernal lights are housed and absorbed in spiritual vessels that contain them in a deep internal manner. Therefore, the descent of the influence through till the lights are contained into vessels testifies as to its settlement. צז Possuk: Devorim (26:2)

ו ל ק ח ת מ ר א ש י ת כ ל - פ ר י ה א ד מ א ש ר ת ב י א מ א ר צ ח א ש ר ה ’ א ל ק י ד נ  
ת נ ל ך ו ש מ ת ב ט נ א ו ה ל כ ת א ל - ה מ ק ו מ א ש ר י ב ח ר ה ’ “ א ל ק י ד ל ש כ נ ש מ ו  
ש ם

**You shall take of the first of all the fruit of the ground, which you will bring from your land, which HaShem, your G-d, is giving you.**

And you shall put them into a basket and go to the place which HaShem, your G-d, will choose to have His Name dwell there.” חצ Continues: Talks about the fulfillment of the Mitzvah of Bikkurim. טצ Receptacle: This refers to drawing down Divine ‘lights’ into ‘vessels’.

letters. This symbolises a ‘Hamshocha’ from above to below. אק And may it be HaShem’s will, that this בק will bring the greatest of blessings, גק when we fulfil the literal meaning of the words “

ו ה י ה כ י ת ב ו א א ל ה א רץ

### **When you will come to land”**

in reality, טק with the coming of our righteous Moshiach, he will come and redeem us and bring us all proudly to our land and in our time. הק The letters: The letters in the Torah come to life and are revealed through the musical notes and through the vowels. This is how the Torah descends and is invested into letters and words that are understood in human intellect. אק Hamshocha from above to below: Through the vowels and notes the Supernal wisdom of HaShem from way up above is comprehended in the human brain down here below. בק That this: General concept of Bikkurim. גק Greatest of blessings: And the biggest blessing of all is the complete redemption. טק In reality: When all of B’nei Yisroel are collected and brought to Eretz Yisroel. As the Possuk states (Yeshayahu 27:12)

ו ה י ה ב י ו מ ש ב ל ת ה נ ה ר ע ד נ ח ל מ צ ר י מ ו א ת מ ל ק ט ו ל  
א ח ד א ח ד ב נ י י ש ר א ל

**“And it shall come to pass on that day, that HaShem shall gather from the flood of the river to the stream of Egypt, and you shall be gathered one by one, O children of Israel”**

הק Our time: At our speed the speed that humans think is fast. Unlike the Possuk in Tehillim (90:4)

This will be achieved specifically through the Mitzvah of prayer which is in place of Bikkurim, about which it says אק “Do this Mitzvah, for because of it, you will enter the land’, and as the Sifri explains: that ‘

means immediately”<sup>17</sup>. And as the Rambam writes: “<sup>18</sup>The Torah promised that at the end [of days], the B’nei Yisroel will repent and

that states:

כי אלף שנים בעיניך כיום “א תמול כי יעברו א שמונה ב ל י לה

**For a thousand years are in Your eyes like yesterday, which passed, and a watch in the night”.**

<sup>17</sup>About which it says: The Sifri says as was brought at the beginning of this Maamor: “Whenever the word ‘והיה’ is used it implies immediately: The Sifri says on this Possuk our Parsha (Devorim 26:1) where it says ”

והיה כי תבוא אל-ה ארץ

**And it shall be when you come to the land”: (whenever the word ‘והיה’**

והיה’ is used it implies immediately) “Perform the Mitzvah mentioned herein, in whose merit you are entering the land”<sup>17</sup>. Means immediately: And so too may the Geulah come immediately! <sup>18</sup>Rambam writes: (Hichos Teshuvah 7:5) “All of the prophets commanded concerning repentance; The B’nei Yisroel will only be redeemed through repentance. Indeed, the Torah long since assured us that in the end, at the close of the period of exile The B’nei Yisroel will turn to repentance and be momentarily redeemed, even as it is said (Devorim 30:1-3): ”

והיה כי יבאו עליך כל הדברים

וגו' "ו ש"

בתעדה' אלהיך" ו

**ש' אלהיך**

וגו" : "And it shall be, when all these things come upon you ... and you will return to HaShem your G-d, ... then HaShem your G-d will return.

immediately they will be redeemed." This means immediately, according to Halacha's definition of immediately, וק' and then, וק' there will be perfection in Torah, perfection of the nation and perfection of the land, and there we will bring the Bikkurim in the Third Beis HaMikdosh, as the Possuk states:

מ ק ד ש ה' כ ו נ נ ו ק י א " י ד יך

### **The sanctuary, HaShem, which Your hands founded,"**

וק' may it be speedily, in our days, in actuality. וק' Immediately: Halacha's definition of 'immediately' is either eighteen minutes or twenty-four minutes. וק' And then: When Moshiach actually comes. וק' Possuk states: (Shmos 15:17)

ת ב א מ ו ו ת ט ע מ ו ב ה ר נ ח ל תך מ כ ו נ ל ש ב תך פ ע ל ת ה' מ ק ד ש ה' כ ו נ נ ו י  
ד יך

"You shall bring them and plant them on the mount of Your heritage, directed toward Your habitation, which You made, HaShem; the sanctuary, HaShem, which Your hands founded." וק' Your hands founded: Referring to third Beis Hamikdosh which will be built by heaven.